

HERMES

MESSENGER OF THE GODS

Hermes' job on Olympus was to carry the messages of the gods to the mortals on Earth. His sandals and hat had wings, so that he could fly to places quickly. Hermes was also responsible for making sure souls traveled safely to the underworld after people died.

PARENTS: Zeus and Maia

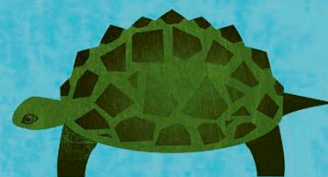
CHILDREN: Many

SACRED SYMBOLS



CROCUS

When his companion Crocus was killed, Hermes turned him into a crocus flower.



TORTOISE

Hermes made the first-ever lyre, a stringed instrument, from the shell of a tortoise.



CADUCEUS

Hermes always carried this staff, which had a pair of snakes twined around it.



TALARIA

These were winged sandals that helped Hermes fly through the air.

DREAM DELIVERER

If the ancient Greeks wished to speak to the gods, they would pray to Hermes before they went to sleep so that he would bring them messages in their dreams. As the god of journeys, he was also worshiped by merchants and travelers.